

Azure Solution Proposal

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CLIENT BACKGROUND

Meadow Fresh Grocers has 12 stores. We use three old servers for sales and stock. Our online ordering site is one year old. It now has four times more users. The site crashes in the evening when many people use it. One server broke down recently. We lost six hours of order data. Our IT team has only two people. They cannot do much maintenance. We need a new system in 10 weeks. This must be done before the holiday shopping time.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVES

- We need to handle traffic spikes without downtime when a lot of people are shopping.
- We also want to reduce the amount of work our small IT team has to do every day to manage our infrastructure.
- We do not want to spend a lot of money upfront because we're not sure how much our business will grow in the future.
- We need to improve how we keep our data safe and make sure we do not lose any order data from our shopping website.

RECOMMENDED SOLUTION

- We are moving to Azure PaaS services. This means we will get rid of the three servers we have at our office. Instead we will use managed services that can automatically add or remove resources as needed. This will help us with all four of our goals. The IT team will not have to worry about taking care of the hardware or the operating system. They will not have to do backups either.
- Azure Front Door + CDN — They store content in locations that are close to our customers. This helps direct traffic in a way. It reduces the load on our backend systems when a lot of people are using them at the time.
- Azure App Service (autoscale) — It can automatically add instances when a lot of people are using the site in the evening. Then it removes those instances at night to save money. .
- Azure SQL Database (geo-redundant) — This new system automatically backs up our data. Has built-in redundancy. This means we do not have to worry about losing our data like we did last month.
- Azure Backup — It helps keep our order and inventory data safe.
- Azure Monitor — It sends alerts to our IT team when it notices any issues. This means they can fix problems before our customers even notice them. This way they do not have to react to problems as they happen.
- **ESTIMATED MONTHLY COST (PAY-AS-YOU-GO)**

Service	Purpose	Est. Monthly
Azure Front Door + CDN	Traffic routing & caching	\$50
App Service (Standard, autoscale 1–3)	Web app hosting	\$160
Azure SQL Database (Standard, geo-redundant)	Order & inventory data	\$100
Azure Backup	Data protection	\$25
Azure Monitor	Uptime & alerting	\$15

Estimated total: ~\$350/month (~\$4,380/year), scaling with actual usage.

Figures are directional estimates built with the Azure Pricing Calculator methodology for planning purposes; final pricing should be confirmed in the official calculator before a client commitment. This replaces an estimated \$15,000–20,000 upfront cost of new on-premises hardware, converting a capital expense into a predictable operating expense.

MIGRATION TIMELINE (10 WEEKS)

- Weeks 1–2: Provision Azure environment, set up App Service and Azure SQL Database
- Weeks 3–5: Migrate application code and data; configure autoscale rules and CDN
- Weeks 6–7: Set up Azure Backup, Monitor alerts, and run load testing to simulate peak traffic
- Weeks 8–9: Parallel run alongside existing on-prem system; validate data integrity
- Week 10: Cutover to Azure, decommission on-prem servers, go live ahead of festive season

KEY RISKS & MITIGATIONS

- Data migration errors — mitigated by a parallel run period (weeks 8–9) before full cutover.
- Team unfamiliarity with Azure tooling — mitigated by Azure Monitor's proactive alerting, reducing reliance on manual troubleshooting.

- Timeline pressure before festive season — mitigated by starting with the highest-impact components (App Service, SQL Database) in weeks 1–5.